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Gillette will build new base in Fort Point

Near giant sign; Procter & Gamble to spend \$1b

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

While its longtime World Shaving Headquarters will soon disappear, Gillette is making a massive new real estate investment that will ensure the iconic shaving brand maintains a visible presence on the Boston landscape for decades to come.

Parent company Procter & Gamble on Tuesday announced it is spending nearly \$1 billion on a new Gillette headquarters in Fort Point, just steps away from its old manufacturing complex and the giant sign that has long greeted commuters at the southern edge of downtown Boston.

Business leaders hailed the news that P&G Gillette would invest heavily in the new headquarters — instead of moving into an existing building — as an important show of faith at a time when Boston's economy remains sluggish and major new construction in particular has been a rare sight.

In 2023, P&G Gillette announced it would move manufacturing operations out of its longtime South Boston site to its campus in Andover and separately would find a new place in the city neighborhood for its roughly 750 corporate and research workers.

P&G Gillette considered leasing other spaces, or staying on its 31-acre existing campus, which is in the early stages of being redeveloped. In the end, though, the company said it

GILLETTE, Page A8

CEO accused of plagiarism now writes book on how to fire

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Peter D. Banko is no stranger to firing workers. As the head of Baystate Health, he's laid off hundreds of employees in less than two years.

The CEO of Western Massachusetts' largest health care system believes he's so skilled at swinging the ax that he's written a book about it: "The Necessary Goodbye: How Great Leaders Fire with Clarity, Confidence, and Compassion."

If the subject raises eyebrows, it won't be the first time Banko has done that with his writing. Last May, he was accused of plagiarism and subsequently apologized for repeatedly using passages from other writers' work in the weekly blog he produced for Baystate's nearly 13,000 employees.

Now he has drawn "from nearly two decades of CEO-level experience" to produce a "practical, eye-opening guide to one of leadership's most misunderstood and avoided responsibilities: firing someone," according to a promotional blurb for the book, which will be published on May 12 by Forbes Books, according to a listing on Amazon.com.

Readers will learn how to "handle termination conversations with empathy and precision," it goes on, how to "reframe firing as a leadership act," and how to "preserve trust, culture, and team morale during tough decisions."

News of the book was first reported by The Republican of Springfield.

BANKO, Page A7

World Cup's luster could be dulled

Boston's struggles with fund-raising may shrink big plans

By Chris Serres, Sean Cotter, and Michael Silverman
GLOBE STAFF

After years of anticipation and preparation, Boston's bold dream of hosting the planet's signature sporting spectacle, the World Cup, now hangs unexpectedly in the balance amid a bitter clash over unresolved yet relatively insignificant security costs.

But this dispute points to some-

thing far more concerning. Business leaders around Greater Boston say the drama around the security issue points to deeper dysfunction and looming financial troubles within the organizing committee, which is now scrambling to pull off the event in less than three months.

Whispers became headlines last week when town leaders of suburban Foxborough — the site of Gillette Stadium, where Boston's seven World

Cup matches are to be held — again refused to grant a permit for the games until the organizers provide upfront nearly \$8 million in security costs.

The dustup has raised uncomfortable questions about Boston's preparations for the massive event, now less than 100 days away. It's unclear if organizers will be able to pull off their grand vision, or if plans will have to be scaled back, perhaps dra-

matically, in the face of funding shortfalls and logistical snafus.

Boston Soccer 26 — a host committee dominated by allies of Patriots owner Robert Kraft — appears well short of the \$170 million goal it said it needed to stage a World Cup that could draw 2 million visitors to Greater Boston. Exactly how short remains a mystery.

The flap in Foxborough pushed Boston Soccer 2026 to make a rare public disclosure last week: It revealed it only has \$2 million in the

WORLD CUP, Page A9



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF



IT'S HISTORY

Demolition has begun on Matthews Arena, the more than century-old home of Northeastern University athletics and a former host of the Celtics and Bruins. It opened in 1910 and was recognized as the world's oldest multipurpose athletic building and the oldest arena still in use for hockey, according to the university. A new, 310,000-square-foot facility, slated to open in the fall of 2028, will house Northeastern's women's and men's hockey and basketball teams.

Democrats flex power with visits to ICE facilities

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As Democrats here seek to show voters they are taking the fight to President Trump, they're increasingly using federal Immigration and Customs Enforcement facilities — and their ability to inspect them — as a backdrop for their messaging.

Immigration detention centers as well as dozens of ICE field offices — where growing numbers of suspected undocumented migrants are being

held in reportedly poor conditions amid the administration's mass deportation effort — are drawing alarm and protest nationwide.

Members of Congress have the authority to conduct unannounced inspections of these facilities, and as backlash to the administration's immigration agenda grows, Democratic lawmakers are exercising that power more and more.

"This is what you want to do if you are worried about what's happening," said Representative Bennie Thomp-

son, a Mississippi Democrat and the ranking member on the House panel that oversees the Department of Homeland Security.

The ICE field office for the Boston region, which sits in a nondescript office park next to the Burlington Mall and Interstate 95, has served as a stage for the broader story.

Since last June, four Massachusetts members of Congress — Senator Ed Markey and Representatives Seth Moulton of Salem, Jake Auchincloss of

ICE, Page A7

The Pentagon said American and Israeli forces are "winning decisively" but did not set a timetable for the end of the war with Iran. **A6.**

Winter-traumatized Boston reveled in a day of record-breaking heat, with the temperature hitting 74. **B1.**

Dana-Farber Cancer Institute and Mass General Brigham said they will work together on the issue of physician assistants. **B5.**

Where do Irish chefs and bartenders go when they want a taste of home? Check out their favorite Boston-area spots. **G1.**

A decade in, Bow Market's special flavor hard to duplicate



DAVID L. RYAN/ GLOBE STAFF

Sam Lee did some embroidery work at Keeper chain stitch embroidery shop at Bow Market in Somerville.

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — In 2016, Zachary Baum and Matthew Boyes-Watson walked into Somerville City Hall with an unorthodox vision: to transform a vacant, U-shaped garage nestled behind a Union Square alleyway into a bustling bazaar of shoebox-sized storefronts called Bow Market.

The pitch raised plenty of eyebrows among the regulators, financiers, and neighbors whose buy-in they needed. But nearly a decade later, their big dream for that former concrete wasteland has turned into a thriving, constantly changing hub of more than two dozen entrepreneurs that hasn't seen a vacancy longer than a month in over two years, according to Baum. Patrons brave even the bitterest temperatures to cozy up at the Nook cocktail bar, browse zero-waste products at Green Tiger & Co., or try their

luck at Pop's Pinball Parlor.

"One of my friends says Bow Market's the center of the universe," said regular patron Sam Farnsworth on a recent Friday.

Somewhere between a small business incubator, a food court, and a European-style piazza, Bow Market stands as a bright spot in the Boston area's brick-and-mortar landscape — a stark contrast to the struggling food halls and shopping malls dotting the region. But even in a region desperate for fresh retail and commercial real estate concepts, Bow Market remains just about as singular as it was when Baum and Boyes-Watson — two local thirty-somethings who run the market full time — pitched it a decade ago. That's because all the things that make Bow the draw that it is, from its quirky use of real estate to its unique vendor mix, are also what can make it so challenging for homegrown projects

BOW MARKET, Page A8

Shorts — stop

Wednesday: Much cooler. High 49-54. Low 44-49.

Thursday: Not bad. High 55-60. Low 28-33.

Sunrise: 7:03 Sunset: 6:46

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00

